

# Zikun Ye

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| CONTACT           | Address: 4277 NE Stevens Way, Paccar Hall 465, Seattle, WA 98195<br>E-mail: zikunye@uw.edu<br>Website: <a href="http://www.zikunye.com">www.zikunye.com</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| EMPLOYMENT        | <b>Michael G. Foster School of Business</b><br><b>University of Washington</b> , Seattle, Washington<br>Assistant Professor of Marketing 2023 - Present                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| EDUCATION         | <b>University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign</b> , Illinois 2018-2023<br>Ph.D., Operations Research<br><b>Shanghai Jiao Tong University</b> , Shanghai, China 2014-2018<br>B.S., Industrial Engineering and Mathematics (Summa cum laude)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| RESEARCH INTEREST | Large Language Models; Digital Marketplace; Quantitative Marketing; Optimization; Causal Inference; Field Experiment; Machine Learning.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| PUBLICATIONS      | <p>† Authors listed alphabetically. * Student advised.</p> <ol style="list-style-type: none"><li>1. Shuai Li*, <b>Zikun Ye</b>, Xin Chen, Weijun Xie. Joint Assortment Optimization and Discrete Marketing Mix Allocation. <i>Manufacturing &amp; Service Operations Management</i>, 2026. [Link]</li><li>2. <b>Zikun Ye</b>, Zhiqi Zhang, Dennis Zhang, Heng Zhang, Renyu Zhang. Deep-Learning-Based Causal Inference for Large-Scale Combinatorial Experiments: Theory and Empirical Evidence. <i>Management Science</i>, 2025. [Link]<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Accepted at <i>ACM Conference on Economics and Computation</i> (EC'23)</li><li>- First Prize, INFORMS Social Media Analytics Best Student Paper Award, 2023</li><li>- Second Prize, CSAMSE Best Paper Award, 2023</li></ul></li><li>3. <b>Zikun Ye</b>, Hema Yoganarasimhan, Yufeng Zheng. LOLA: LLM-Assisted Online Learning Algorithm for Content Experiments. <i>Marketing Science</i>, 2025. [Link]<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Quantitative Marketing and Economics (QME) Conference, 2024</li></ul></li><li>4. Xin Chen, Niao He, Yifan Hu, <b>Zikun Ye</b><sup>†</sup>. Efficient Algorithms for a Class of Stochastic Hidden Convex Optimization and Its Applications in Network Revenue Management. <i>Operations Research</i>, 2024. [Link]</li><li>5. <b>Zikun Ye</b>, Dennis Zhang, Heng Zhang, Renyu Zhang, Xin Chen. Cold Start to Improve Market Thickness on Online Advertising Platforms: Data-Driven Algorithms and Field Experiments. <i>Management Science</i>, 2023. [Link]<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Finalist, INFORMS RMP Section Jeff McGill Best Student Paper, 2020.</li></ul></li></ol> |

WORKING PAPER\$6. **Zikun Ye**, Hema Yoganarasimhan. Fair Document Valuation in LLM Summaries via Shapley Values, *minor revision in Management Science*. [Link]

7. Lei Wang\*, **Zikun Ye**, Jinglong Zhao<sup>†</sup>. Efficient Inference Using Large Language Models with Limited Human Data: Fine-Tuning then Rectification, *under review*. [Link]
8. **Zikun Ye**, Jiameng Lyu, Rui Tao. Allocating Human Oversight in AI-Enabled Analytics, *under review*. [Link]
9. **Zikun Ye**, Hema Yoganarasimhan. Rectification Difficulty and Optimal Sample Allocation in LLM-Augmented Surveys, *under review*. [Link]

CONFERENCE  
PRESENTATIONS

Document Valuation in LLM Summaries.

|                                      |      |
|--------------------------------------|------|
| WUSTL Marketing Junior Faculty Forum | 2025 |
| MIT DSL                              | 2025 |
| AIM 2025                             | 2025 |
| ISMS 2025                            | 2025 |

LOLA: LLM-Assisted Online Learning Algorithm for Content Experiments.

|                               |      |
|-------------------------------|------|
| ISMS 2024, Sydney             | 2024 |
| UW-UBC                        | 2024 |
| Shanghai Jiao Tong University | 2024 |
| WUSTL Olin Business School    | 2024 |
| QME, Stanford GSB             | 2024 |
| MarkTech, Columbia CBS        | 2024 |

Deep-Learning-Based Causal Inference for Large-Scale Combinatorial Experiments.

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|----------------------------------------|----------|
| China-India Insight Program, Hong Kong | 2024     |
| WUSTL Olin Business School             | 2024     |
| ACM EC, London                         | Jul 2023 |
| INFORMS RMP, London, UK                | Jul 2023 |
| MSOM Conference, Montreal, CA          | Jun 2023 |
| POMS Annual Conference                 | May 2023 |
| 2022 Conference on AI, ML, and BA, HBS | Dec 2022 |
| NFORMS ISMS Conference, Online         | Jun 2022 |

Efficient Algorithms for Minimizing Compositions of Convex Functions and Random Functions.

|                                       |          |
|---------------------------------------|----------|
| POMS Annual Conference,               | May 2023 |
| INFORMS Annual Meeting, Indianapolis  | Oct 2022 |
| MSOM SIG in SCM, Munich, Germany      | Jun 2022 |
| INFORMS RMP Spotlight Session, Online | Jun 2022 |
| POMS Annual Conference, Online        | May 2022 |

Cold Start to Improve Market Thickness.

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|------------------------------------------------|----------|
| MSOM SIG in Service Management, Munich         | Jun 2022 |
| INFORMS RMP Spotlight Session, Online          | Jun 2022 |
| MIW, Online                                    | May 2022 |
| POMS Annual Conference, Online                 | May 2022 |
| Cornell ORIE Young Researcher Workshop, Ithaca | Oct 2021 |

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|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| TEACHING<br>EXPERIENCE | MKTG 464 Analytics for Marketing Decisions                           |             |
|                        | MKTG 564 Analytics for Marketing Decisions                           |             |
|                        | BUS AN 599 Business Analytics Practicum                              |             |
|                        | MKTG 579 Business Applications of LLMS & Generative Models           |             |
|                        | IE 310 Deterministic Models in Optimization (UIUC)                   |             |
| HONORS AND<br>AWARDS   | First Prize, INFORMS Social Media Analytics Best Student Paper Award | 2023        |
|                        | Second Prize, CSAMSE Best Paper Award                                | 2023        |
|                        | Finalist Jeff McGill Student Paper Prize, INFORMS RMP Section        | 2020        |
|                        | Teachers Ranked as Excellent by Students, UIUC                       | 2022        |
|                        | William A Chittenden II Award, UIUC                                  | 2021        |
| INDUSTRY<br>EXPERIENCE | <i>Research Intern</i> , Walmart Lab                                 | Summer 2022 |
|                        | <i>Economist/Ops. Research Intern</i> , Kwai Inc.                    | 2019 - 2020 |
|                        | <i>Data Analyst Intern</i> , Didi.com                                | Summer 2018 |
| ACADEMIC<br>SERVICES   | Editorial Review Board                                               |             |
|                        | - <i>Marketing Science</i>                                           |             |
|                        | Referee                                                              |             |
|                        | - <i>Management Science</i>                                          |             |
|                        | - <i>Operations Research</i>                                         |             |
|                        | - <i>Journal of Marketing Research</i>                               |             |
|                        | - <i>Manufacturing &amp; Service Operations Management</i>           |             |
|                        | - <i>Production and Operations Management</i>                        |             |
|                        | - <i>Conference - EC, WWW, NeurIPS</i>                               |             |
|                        | Session Chair, INFORMS Annual Meeting, 2022, 2023, 2025              |             |
|                        | Session Chair, ISMS 2025                                             |             |
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